The cases are here on writs of certiorari which we granted. 405 U. S. 1039.

The Equal Protection Clause does not mean that a State may not draw lines that treat one class of individuals or entities differently from the others. The test is whether the difference in treatment is an invidious discrimination. *Harper* v. *Virginia Board of Elections,* 383 U. S. 663, 666. Where taxation is concerned and no specific federal right, apart from equal protection, is imperiled,[3] the States have large leeway in making classifications and drawing lines which in their judgment produce reasonable systems of taxation. As stated in *Allied Stores of Ohio* v. *Bowers,* 358 U. S. 522, 526–527:

> "The States have a very wide discretion in the laying of their taxes. When dealing with their proper domestic concerns, and not trenching upon the prerogatives of the National Government or violating the guaranties of the Federal Constitution, the States have the attribute of sovereign powers in devising their fiscal systems to ensure revenue and foster their local interests. Of course, the States, in the exercise of their taxing power, are subject to the requirements of the Equal Protection Clause of the Fourteenth Amendment. But that clause imposes no iron rule of equality, prohibiting the flexibility and variety that are appropriate to reasonable schemes of state taxation. The State may impose different specific taxes upon different trades and

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a petition to file original suit with that court by one Maynard, who owned nonbusiness personal property, and by three school districts. That petition was dismissed.

[3] Classic examples are the taxes that discriminated against newspapers, struck down under the First Amendment (*Grosjean* v. *American Press Co.,* 297 U. S. 233) or that discriminated against interstate commerce (see *Michigan-Wisconsin Pipe Line Co.* v. *Calvert,* 347 U. S. 157) or required licenses to engage in interstate commerce.